

User Guide

F5-to-Alteon Migration Tool

Written by Sean Ramati

Professional Services

Version 0.5.6

July, 2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Overview	3
Requirements	3
Installation.....	3
Run instantly with npx (recommended)	3
Or install globally.....	3
Or run from source	4
Supported Inputs	4
Step-by-Step Migration.....	4
Step 1 - Convert.....	4
Step 2 - Review the logs.....	5
Step 3 - Apply on the Alteon	5
Step 4 - Verify traffic	5
Command Reference.....	5
Route Domains.....	5
What Is Converted.....	6
Validation Summary	6
Troubleshooting.....	6
References	7

Overview

The F5-to-Alteon migration tool converts an F5 BIG-IP LTM configuration into Radware Alteon CLI commands. Feed it whatever export you have - a qkview or UCS support archive, an extracted archive folder, or bare configuration files - and it produces a ready-to-apply Alteon configuration plus two review logs that account for every object it could not fully convert. Nothing is silently dropped.

Every conversion path has been validated against live Alteon appliances (34.0.x and 34.5.x), including a behavioral round-trip against a live BIG-IP 17.5 and packet-level traffic tests of generated configurations. The tool covers everything the legacy F5-Migration tool converted, and adds route domains (Alteon Network Segmentation or per-route-domain splitting) and wildcard/forwarding virtual servers (Alteon filters).

Requirements

The only requirement is Node.js 16 or newer, on Windows, macOS, or Linux. There are no other dependencies. Verify with:

```
node --version
```

If Node.js is missing, install it from nodejs.org or with your package manager:

```
winget install OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS      # Windows
brew install node                     # macOS
sudo apt install nodejs npm           # Linux (Debian/Ubuntu)
```

Installation

All options behave identically in Windows PowerShell or CMD, macOS Terminal, and Linux shells.

Run instantly with npx (recommended)

```
npx @radware/f5-to-alteon device.qkview -o out/
```

Or install globally

```
npm install -g @radware/f5-to-alteon
f5-to-alteon device.qkview -o out/
```

Or run from source

```
git clone https://github.com/Radware/F5-to-Alteon-Migrator.git
cd F5-to-Alteon-Migrator/node
node bin/f5-to-alteon.js device.qkview -o out/
```

Supported Inputs

The input type is auto-detected by content, not by file extension. Any one of the following works:

- A qkview support archive (multi-gigabyte is fine; the config is streamed out in seconds).
- A UCS backup archive.
- An extracted qkview or UCS folder.
- Bare configuration files: bigip_base.conf and bigip.conf together, or a single bigip.conf.
- A folder containing configs from several devices - the tool lists the devices it finds and asks which one to convert.

To export from the F5 side, save the configuration and take /config/bigip.conf and /config/bigip_base.conf - or simply generate a qkview and feed it whole:

```
tmsh save sys config
```

Step-by-Step Migration

Step 1 - Convert

```
npx @radware/f5-to-alteon device.qkview -o out/ --name mydevice
```

The tool prints a one-line summary and writes three files: mydevice_output.txt (the Alteon CLI configuration), mydevice_log1.txt (manual-completion items - converted with a caveat to review, such as renamed IDs or port mappings), and mydevice_log2.txt (possibly-unsupported items - F5 features with no automatic Alteon equivalent, each with guidance).

Step 2 – Review the logs

Every log entry names the F5 object, describes the issue, and suggests the course of action. Typical items: names longer than Alteon's 32-character limit were renamed (references updated automatically), physical F5 ports need re-mapping to the target chassis, an iRule needs a manual equivalent.

Step 3 – Apply on the Alteon

Paste the output into an Alteon CLI session (or stream it over SSH), then activate it:

```
apply
```

The output is ordered so objects are defined before they are referenced. Review with the `/info` and `/cfg` menus, and only then save to FLASH.

Step 4 – Verify traffic

Confirm virtual servers serve traffic, health checks track real-server state, and persistence behaves as on the source. If the source F5 used SNAT automap, assign a dedicated proxy IP (PIP) on the flagged virtual services – the conversion log marks exactly where.

Command Reference

- `-o, --out <dir>` - output directory (default: alongside the input).
- `--name <prefix>` - output filename prefix (default: derived from the input name).
- `--rd-mode auto|segment|split` - route-domain handling (default: auto).

Route Domains

F5 route domains (addresses such as 10.1.2.3%4) are converted, not ignored:

- `auto` (default): route domains with non-overlapping address space land on ONE Alteon using Network Segmentation – each route domain becomes an Alteon segment with its VLANs, virtual servers get segment classifiers with Return-to-Last-Hop, and a per-segment redirect filter forwards cross-segment traffic to that segment's gateway. Overlapping address space automatically falls back to splitting.

- split: one self-contained output file per route domain, each for its own Alteon instance (vADC or VA).
- segment: force segmentation; falls back to split, with a warning, if route domains overlap.

What Is Converted

Server load balancing: nodes/realms, monitors (built-in and custom, AND/OR combinations), pools/groups (metrics, priority-group to backup), virtual servers, persistence (client IP, cookie), profiles (HTTP/XFF, SSL, OneConnect), SNAT pools. Wildcard and forwarding virtual servers become Alteon filters with automatic port bindings. Networking: VLANs, self-IPs, floating IPs, static routes and gateways, trunks/LACP. System: management, NTP, syslog, SNMP.

iRules, GTM/GSLB, and administrative partitions are not auto-converted - each produces a named diagnostic with guidance instead of a silent drop. The full conversion ledger is in DELTAS.md in the repository.

Validation Summary

- 39 real production device configurations staged on live Alteon 34.0.12.0 and 34.5.7.0 - zero remaining converter defects.
- Behavioral round-trip against a live BIG-IP VE 17.5: identical load-balancing distribution, persistence, and health behavior.
- 11 constructs traffic-proven individually; Network Segmentation proven at packet level (VIP service, cross-segment redirect, segment isolation).
- 37 defects found and fixed during validation, each locked by a regression test (79 automated tests).

Troubleshooting

- npx: command not found - Node.js is not installed or not on PATH (see Requirements).
- "No F5 config found" on an archive - the archive does not contain config/bigip.conf; for multi-device folders the tool lists what it found.

- A line is rejected on apply - check log1: platform-capacity limits and physical-port mappings are flagged there. Validated targets are Alteon 34.x.
- Cookie persistence rejected - the target Alteon needs the cookie-persistence license; the generated syntax is correct on licensed units.

References

- npm package: npmjs.com/package/@radware/f5-to-alteon
- Source, issues, and validation reports: github.com/Radware/F5-to-Alteon-Migrator